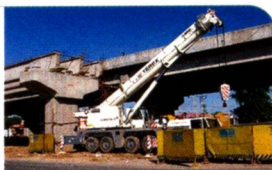


INFRASTRUCTURE

Infrastructure for the people requires us to look at a set of variables that reflect how the common man benefits from infrastructure—and not large industry or commercial enterprises. Consequently, we include the percentage of homes that have electricity connections, the percentage of villages that are connected to pucca roads, overall road length on a per capita basis and the spread of bank branches on a per capita basis. Access to energy is captured not just by electricity connections but also by including the number of domestic LPG connections on a per household basis. Communications-related infrastructure is captured by fixed lines and mobile connections on a per capita basis, and also by post offices normalised by the total population of the state.



BIG STATES

RANK			RANK					
2009		2009*	2008	2007	2006	2005	2004	2003
1	PUNJAB	6.27	1	1	1	1	1	2
2	KERALA	6.04	3	3	3	6	7	3
3	HIMACHAL PRADESH	5.86	2	2	2	2	2	1
4	MAHARASHTRA	5.33	5	6	4	3	3	6
5	HARYANA	5.10	7	4	6	4	6	5
6	TAMIL NADU	5.08	4	7	5	9	8	4
7	KARNATAKA	5.04	6	8	7	10	9	9
8	GUJARAT	4.92	8	9	9	7	5	7
9	JAMMU & KASHMIR	4.80	10	11	11	8	10	8
10	ANDHRA PRADESH	4.71	9	10	10	11	11	10
11	RAJASTHAN	4.15	12	13	13	12	12	11
12	MADHYA PRADESH	3.95	13	12	12	13	13	12
13	WEST BENGAL	3.55	14	15	15	14	14	13
14	UTTAR PRADESH	3.12	15	18	18	16	17	14
15	ORISSA	3.08	16	16	16	18	18	15
16	UTTARAKHAND	2.84	11	5	8	5	4	--
17	ASSAM	2.83	17	17	17	15	15	16
18	BIHAR	2.66	19	20	20	20	20	17
19	CHHATTISGARH	1.87	18	14	14	17	16	--
20	JHARKHAND	1.43	20	19	19	19	19	--

SMALL STATES

1	DELHI	11.96	1	1	1	1	1	2
2	GOA	4.57	2	2	2	2	2	1
3	MIZORAM	3.20	4	4	4	4	4	--
4	SIKKIM	3.13	5	5	5	5	5	--
5	PUDUCHERRY	2.98	3	3	3	3	3	--
6	TRIPURA	2.21	10	8	9	9	8	--
7	NAGALAND	2.19	8	9	8	8	9	--
8	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	2.15	6	6	6	6	6	--
9	MANIPUR	1.86	7	7	7	7	7	--
10	MEGHALAYA	1.73	9	10	10	10	10	--

Rank went down Constant rank Rank went up Fastest Mover

30,000 teachers short. We've filled half of the vacancies and are catering to 11,000 more in the next three months," adds Badal. Unfazed about the criticism on the scrapping of the MOU with Reliance Industries for setting up agricultural projects in the state, Kalia says, "They did nothing for two years. So they had to go."

The Government's moves evoke a mixed reaction. "They are providing the right infrastructure and things are beginning to happen. With IIT and ISB, Punjab will get a different feel," says NASSCOM Chairman Pramod Bhasin. Pointing to depleting water levels and overuse of chemicals and fertilisers, agriculturist Davinder Sharma says, "Punjab is surviving on artificial respiration. The way things are, the most productive land will soon turn into a desert."

The Congress too has its reservations. "Every other day, explosives are found somewhere, indicating an attempt by terrorists to regroup. Law and order is pathetic and standard of education is falling. The Government can only think of how it can crown Badal as chief minister," says Congress MP Vijay Inder Singla from Sangrur. While the debate rages, the paradox that is Punjab continues to make headlines. *by Arvind Chhabra*

DELHI

CAPITAL GLORY

• Tops in Consumer Markets and Infrastructure

Around a decade ago, the national capital was known for its pollution and chaos on roads. The rapid growth of unauthorised colonies had made matters worse. Over 50 per cent of power was lost to theft in transmission and distribution. The public transport system was more of a bane than a boon. Today, however, things are different. With the coming of the Delhi Metro, the public transport has got an indispensable facelift. Around 1,000 unauthorised colonies are in the process of regularisation with improved infrastructure and 7,000 flats have been constructed to accommodate people living in jhuggis. Post-privatisation, the



PUNJAB IS THE FASTEST MOVER (2003-09)

Interplay of its historically strong fundamentals in infrastructure and consumerism has helped the state cling to the No. 1 status in the development matrix.